Community Budget Review Committee
Meeting Minutes

Wednesday, March 4, 2026
5:30pm - 7:30pm ~ Via Zoom

Presiding Officer: Adriel Person, Co-Chair
Staff Support: Office of Family & Community Engagement, Office of Finance Administration

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Committee Members Present:

Aaron Cronan	Angela Bonilla	Karanja Crews	Shain Corey
Adriel Person*	Anna Toll**	Laura Hernandez	Shannon Staley
Andy Jacob	Julia Plowman	Rhonda Gray	Sirena Chen**

PPS Staff and Board Liaison Present:

Alexandra Martin	Michelle Morrison	Patte Sullivan***	Tami Booth
Cheryl Pitman	Nichole Watson	Renard Adams, Ph.D.	Terry Proctor
Jamaal Tibbs			

Committee Members Not Present:

Anne Cherry	Emma Lee**	Minyana Bishop	Paxton Tomczyk**
Eli Posada**	Jen Gray-O'Connor		

* Committee Chair ** Student Member *** Board Liaison

Meeting Called to Order
Presiding Officer Adriel Person greeted members of the Community Budget Review Committee (CBRC) and called the March 4, 2026 meeting to order at 5:35 p.m.

Welcome and Introductions
Facilitator Nichole Watson welcomed members and reviewed the meeting agenda.

Housekeeping
Nichole Watson referenced the previous month's discussion regarding ways for committee members to share questions both during and outside of meetings. She reviewed the CBRC Questions Form and the associated Q&A Tracking Sheet, which includes responses to questions submitted through the form, as

well as questions raised during CBRC meetings. Committee members may also contact logistical support staff member Cheryl Pitman (cpitman@pps.net) directly with any questions or for assistance. Budget Director Tami Booth reviewed the committee's meeting schedule and highlighted the upcoming joint work session between the CBRC and the Board on March 31. Committee members may attend either virtually or in person. Tami Booth asked members to notify staff if they plan to attend in person so that adequate seating can be reserved.

PPS Equity Framework
Nichole Watson reviewed the PPS equity lens, with focus on transparent and student-centered decisions.

CBRC Leadership Selection
Nichole Watson reviewed three slides -- "Our Why," the CBRC Charter, and Meeting and Committee Norms – that provide context and guidance for members and outline expectations for meeting conduct. She also outlined key leadership decisions before the committee at this meeting.

Nichole Watson also reviewed CBRC leadership duties in the context of the committee's responsibility to review, evaluate, and provide a report of recommendations to the Board of Education. As such, the committee would need to determine whether to vote on leadership structure at this meeting or to defer until the March 31 meeting.

Committee members discussed the committee's role in reviewing and evaluating budget information in order to develop recommendations for the Board of Education. Questions were raised regarding whether the committee would have sufficient time to fully analyze information within the current timeline. Staff noted that committee members have access to staff support and may submit questions or request additional information as needed. Staff also acknowledged the compressed timeline and encouraged members to submit questions early so that staff can gather relevant information.

Committee members also raised questions about the format and comparability of budget data across years and expressed interest in access to underlying data sources to support analysis. Staff acknowledged the request and noted that additional information could be provided where available.

Nichole Watson then led a discussion of committee leadership structure, including whether to vote on a structure, elect members to leadership roles, or postpone the decision until the March 31 meeting. Adriel Person, who served as a co-chair during the previous year, is currently serving as Presiding Officer until the committee determines its leadership structure.

The Presiding Officer's responsibilities include convening meetings, supporting facilitation, maintaining meeting flow and adjourning meetings and, most importantly, supporting development of the committee's report by coordinating section assignments, assisting with synthesis of input, ensuring progress toward completion, and supporting consensus-building among members.

Committee members asked about leadership structures used in prior years. According to staff, previous committees have used a variety of models, including co-chairs sharing responsibilities or a chair and vice-chair structure, often reflecting the prior experience of committee members.

Members noted that the volume of work associated with the committee's charge can be significant and that a shared leadership structure may help distribute responsibilities among multiple members. Suggestions included establishing co-chairs and additional vice-chair roles to help manage the workload.

The committee discussed whether to make a decision regarding leadership structure at the current meeting or defer the decision until the next meeting. Some members expressed support for voting at this meeting in order to establish leadership roles promptly and support the committee's work within the limited timeframe.

During the discussion, a student member revisited a question raised at the February meeting regarding the voting status of student representatives. Nichole Watson reported that she consulted with District legal counsel and clarified that current policy does not permit student members of Board committees to cast official votes. She noted that at the Board level, the student representative's vote is not official but is recorded in the meeting minutes. Nichole Watson encouraged student representatives to share their perspectives and to vote for the record at CBRC meetings, noting that the issue has been documented and may be revisited in the future.

Committee members noted the limited timeline for completing the committee's work and discussed the value of establishing a leadership structure promptly in order to begin organizing the report development process.

Angela Bonilla moved, and Andy Jacob seconded, a motion to establish a leadership structure consisting of a chair and a vice-chair for the current year. After brief discussion, Adriel Person moved to amend the motion for leadership structure to consist of two co-chairs and one vice-chair. The amendment was seconded by Angela Bonilla.

Nichole Watson opened the floor for discussion. A member suggested that the committee proceed to finalize the motion currently on the floor. Angela Bonilla then moved to close debate, and Andy Jacob seconded the motion.

The motion to close debate was carried with eleven votes (including one student) in favor, none opposed, and one abstention.

In Favor:		**Opposed:**	**Abstentions:**
Aaron Cronan	Laura Hernandez	None	Anna Toll***
Adriel Person	Rhonda Gray		
Andy Jacob	Shain Corey		
Angela Bonilla	Shannon Staley		
Julia Plowman	Sirena Chen***		
Karanja Crews			

The committee discussed interest in leadership roles; several members expressed willingness to serve in various capacities, including co-chair and vice-chair positions.

Members considered potential processes for identifying and selecting candidates, including providing an opportunity for interested members to share their perspectives and relevant experience; suggestions included using a form to gather candidate statements.

Staff noted that collecting written candidate statements would represent a new approach for the committee, though in prior years interested members have informally shared their perspectives and priorities before a vote. Members also discussed possible voting methods; however, it was noted that electronic voting would not be appropriate within the format of a public meeting.

Angela Bonilla moved, and Adriel Person seconded, the nomination of Adriel Person and Karanja Crews to serve as co-chairs of the CBRC for the current year. The floor was opened for discussion, and the nominees briefly shared introductory remarks. Nichole Watson then called for a vote.

The motion was carried with twelve votes (including two students) in favor, none opposed, and one abstention.

In Favor:		Opposed:	Abstentions:
Aaron Cronan	Karanja Crews	None	None
Adriel Person	Laura Hernandez		
Andy Jacob	Rhonda Gray		
Angela Bonilla	Shain Corey		
Anna Toll***	Shannon Staley		
Julia Plowman	Sirena Chen***		

Adriel Person moved, and Shain Corey seconded, election of Angela Bonilla as vice-chair; Angela Bonilla shared information about herself.

The motion was carried with ten votes (including one student), none opposed and two abstentions.

In Favor:		Opposed:	Abstentions:
Aaron Cronan	Laura Hernandez	None	Karanja Crews
Adriel Person	Rhonda Gray		Anna Toll***
Andy Jacob	Shain Corey		
Angela Bonilla	Shannon Staley		
Julia Plowman	Sirena Chen***		

Budget Hold'Em Activity Preview

Tami Booth introduced the Budget Hold 'Em tool, which will provide an accessible format for committee community members to explore budget trade-offs using actual PPS numbers. Members were encouraged to familiarize themselves with the tool prior to future meetings.

Budget Update
CFO Michelle Morrison provided an update on the current fiscal year, noting that budget variances have occurred due to:

- Lower vacancy savings than projected
- Higher transportation and maintenance costs
- Emergency facility expenses
- Three federal lawsuits
- Local Option Levy shortfall

Review Questions and Answers
Committee members engaged in a question and answer discussion with district staff, including Dr. Renard Adams, Chief Accountability and Equity Officer, focusing on:

- Counselor allocation
- Analysis of Educational Assistant allocation vs. overage pay
- Staffing "add-backs"
- Discretionary building administrator choices

Staff reiterated encouragement to members to submit additional questions through the formal question intake process so responses can be shared with the full Committee. Budget Manager Alexandra Martin noted that the tracking sheet includes separate tabs for each source of questions.

Final Thoughts and Feedback
Chief Morrison expressed gratitude to staff for the robust CBRC Q&A document. Committee members were also encouraged to access Chief Morrison's 12-minute Board of Education 2025-26 Budget Update that was presented at their February 24 meeting.

Additional CBRC meetings will follow in March, April, and May as the Committee prepares its recommendations to the Board.

Adjournment
Co-Chair Person thanked the committee for its time and work, and adjourned the meeting at 7:29 p.m..

Submitted by: Cheryl Pitman, Confidential Executive Assistant to the CFO
Next Meeting: CBRC and Board of Education Joint Work Session
March 31, 6:00-9:00 p.m. (time depending on placement on Board agenda)
Prophet Education Center.

The video recording of this meeting is available for viewing at: LINK